Security Camera

Setup and user guide — from first power-on to watching from anywhere

1 What you need
2 First setup
3 Live view and security
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6 Access from the internet
7 Troubleshooting



1 What you need

Make sure everything is at hand. The setup itself takes about 5 minutes.

📷 **ESP32-CAM camera**
with the firmware already installed

💾 **microSD memory card**
up to 32 GB, FAT32 — videos are saved here

🔌 **5 V power supply**
an ordinary USB phone charger, 1 A or more

📱 **Phone or computer**
with any browser: Chrome, Safari, Firefox

📶 **2.4 GHz home Wi-Fi**
and its password. The camera can't see 5 GHz networks

🔑 **A new password for the camera**
at least 8 characters, not “12345678”

💡 **Where to put the camera.** Close enough to the router for a stable Wi-Fi signal. Don't point it at swaying trees or curtains — they can trigger as “motion”.

2 First setup

The camera creates its own Wi-Fi network that you use to set it up.

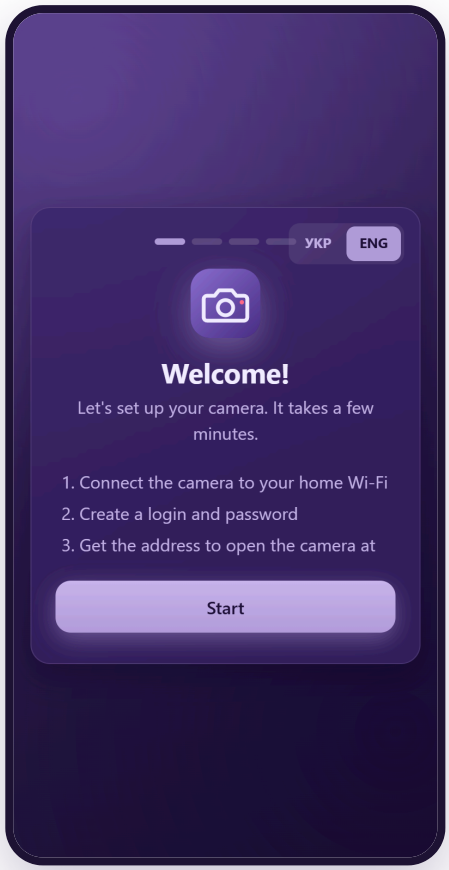
Step 1. Turn the camera on

1. Insert the memory card into the camera's slot (contacts facing the board).
2. Connect the power. Wait about 10 seconds.

Step 2. Join the camera's network

1. On your phone, open **Settings → Wi-Fi**.
2. Find the network `ESP32-Camera-XXXX` (XXXX is four letters or digits) and connect. No password is needed.
3. The setup page **opens by itself**. If it doesn't, open a browser and go to `192.168.4.1`.

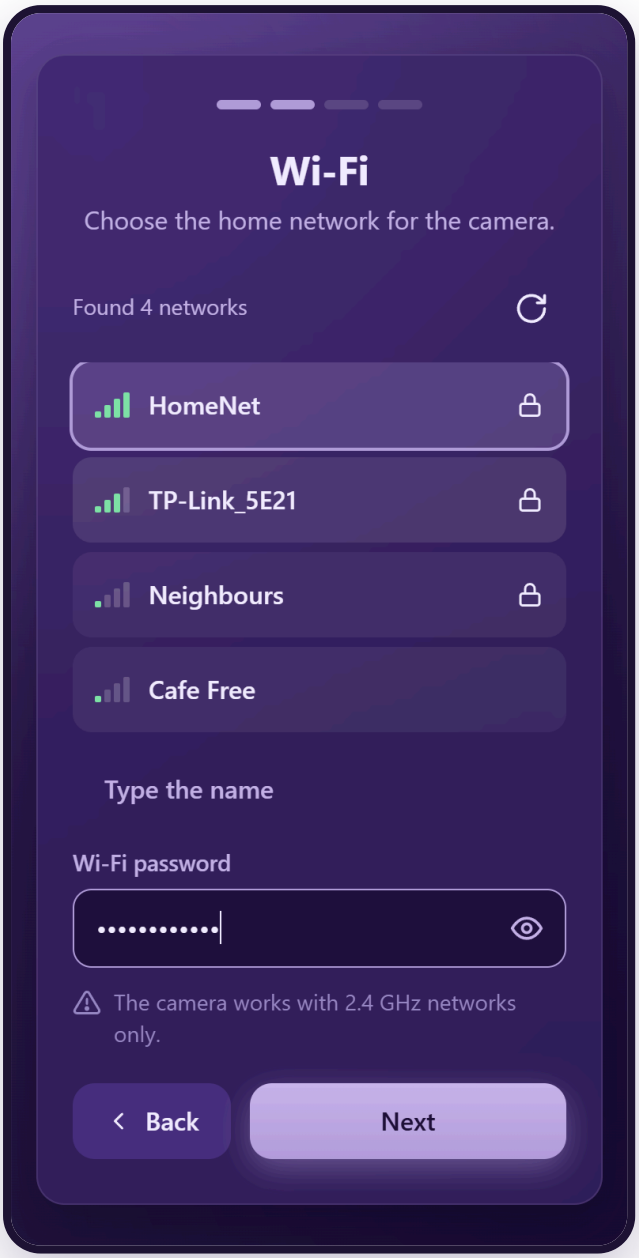
> ⚠️ Your phone may say “No internet connection” and offer to disconnect. Choose **“Stay connected”** — no internet is needed for this step.



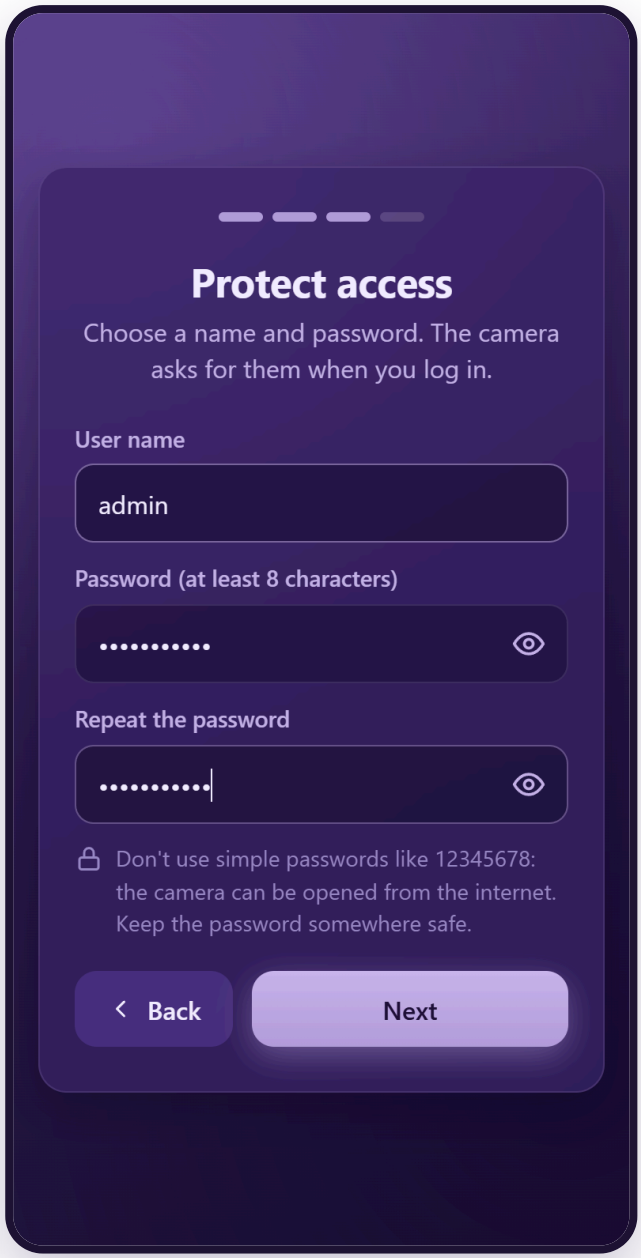
This is the first page.
Tap “Start”.

Step 3. Follow the setup wizard

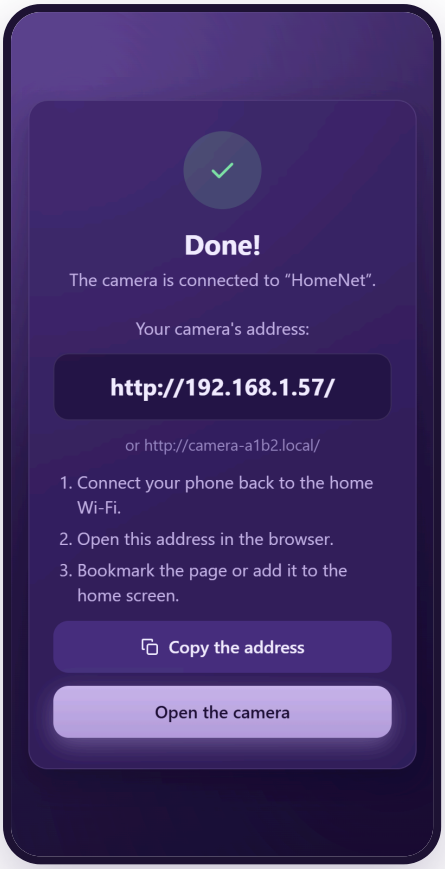
The wizard has four short steps. Switch the language with the **УКР** / **ENG** buttons at the top.



Wi-Fi. Pick your home network from the list and enter its password. Not in the list? Tap **Type the name**.



Protect access. Choose a user name and password for the camera. **Write them down** — you'll need them every time you log in.



Step 4. Done!

The camera joins your home network and shows **its address**, for example `http://192.168.1.57/`.

1. Tap **Copy the address** or take a photo of the screen.
2. Switch your phone back to your **home Wi-Fi**.
3. Open the address in the browser and log in with your new password.
4. Bookmark the page or add it to the home screen — then the camera opens like an app.

✅ The `ESP32-Camera-XXXX` network disappears by itself after a few minutes — that's expected.

⚠️ **“Couldn't connect”?** Usually it's a wrong Wi-Fi password or a 5 GHz network. Tap **Try again** and check the password.

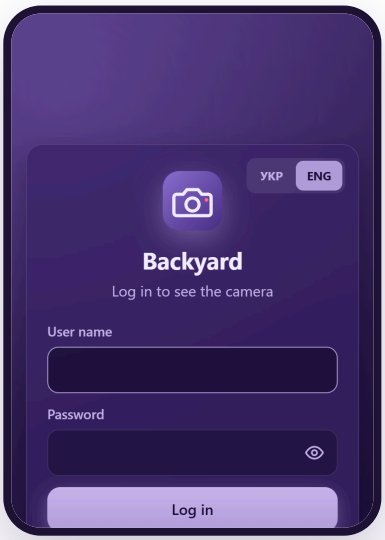
💡 An address like `http://camera-xxxx.local/` also works on iPhone, Mac and most computers — no need to remember numbers.

Logging in

The camera asks for your user name and password each time you open it. Your browser can remember them.

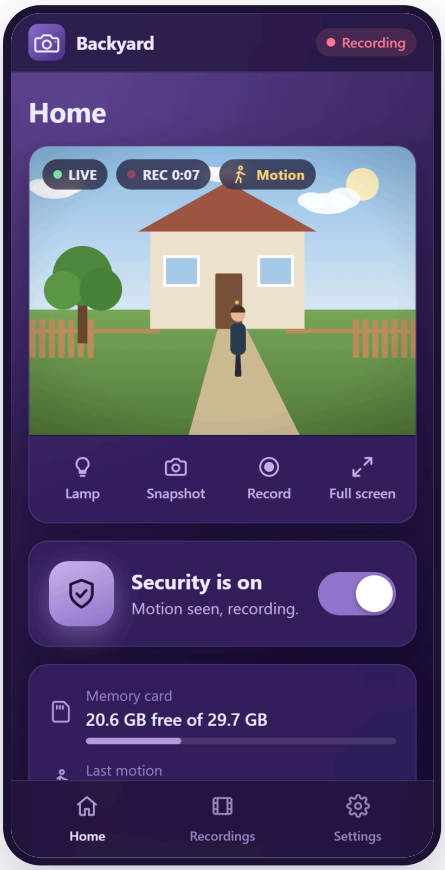
After several wrong attempts, logging in is paused for a while — this protects against password guessing.

Forgot the password? See section **7. Troubleshooting**.



3 Live view and security

The home screen shows live video and the main security switch.



Buttons under the video

Lamp	turns on the camera's flash, on boards that have one; brightness is adjustable
Snapshot	saves a photo to your phone
Record	starts recording manually; tap again to stop
Full screen	shows the video full screen

Security

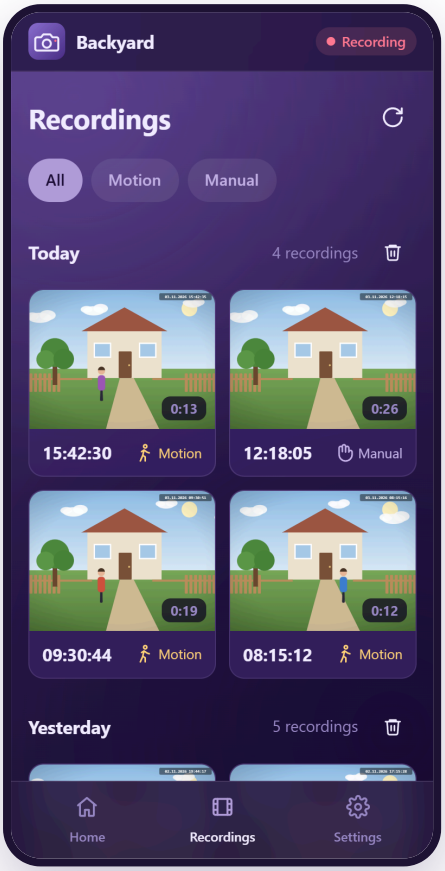
When the **Security** switch is on, the camera records video by itself as soon as it sees motion — including a few seconds from **before** the motion started.

While recording, **● Recording** lights up at the top and **Motion** appears on the video.

> 💡 Further down the home screen: free space on the card, time of the last motion, Wi-Fi signal and the latest recordings.

4 Recordings

All videos are stored on the memory card inside the camera — nothing goes to someone else's cloud.

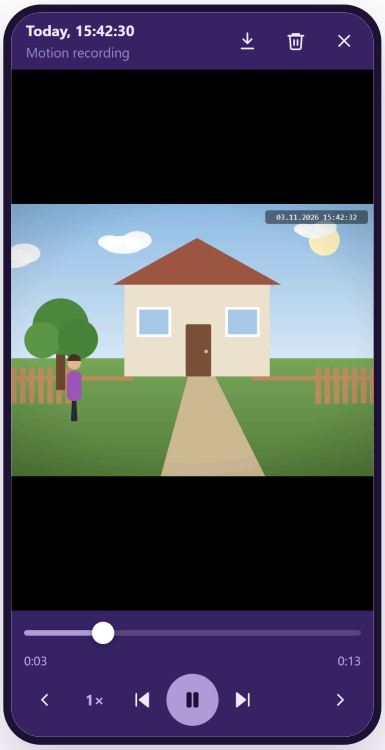


- Recordings are grouped by day: **Today**, **Yesterday** and so on.
- Filter at the top: `All`, `Motion` or `Manual`.
- Tap a recording to watch it.
- The bin button next to a day deletes all recordings from that day.

> ♻ When the card fills up, **the oldest recordings are deleted automatically**. You never need to clean up by hand.

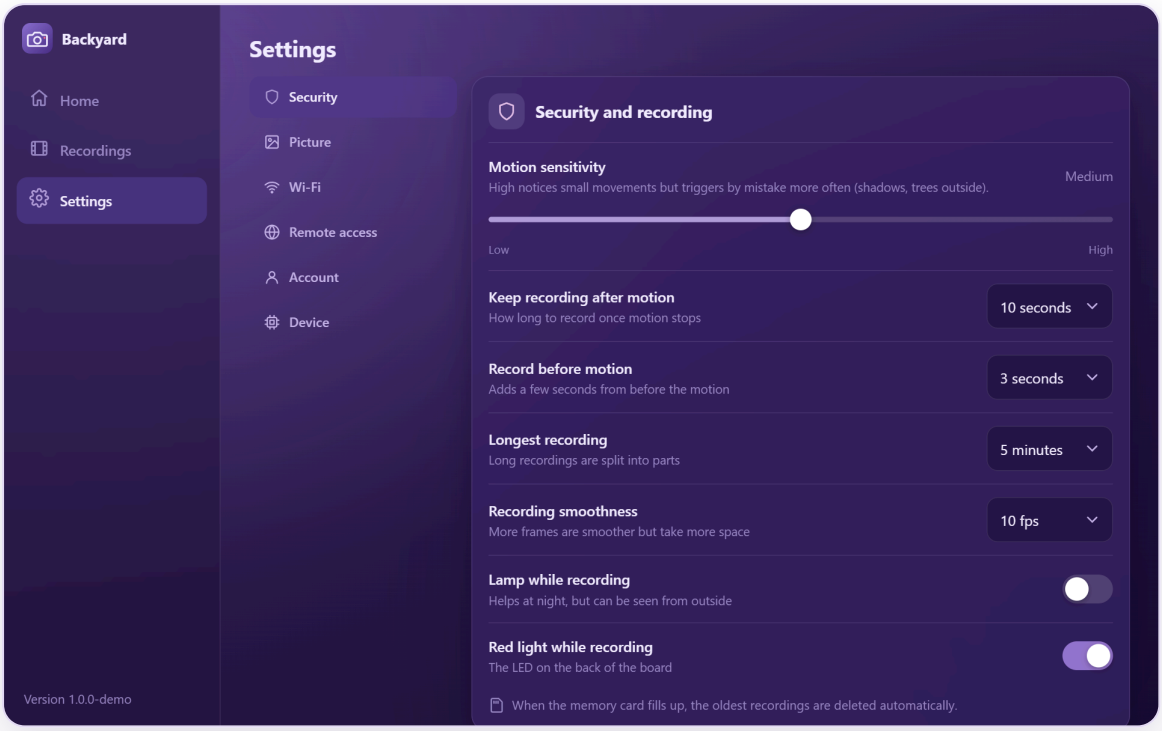
Player

- The slider seeks; the `1×` button changes speed.
- The ‹ › arrows go to the previous and next recording.
- At the top: **download** the file to your phone or computer, **delete**, **close**.
- Downloads are `.mp4` videos that play on any phone or computer. At home the video is prepared while you wait, about as long as the clip itself, so keep the page open. If a `Save` button appears, tap it.



5 Settings

The **Settings** tab has six sections. Changes are saved immediately.



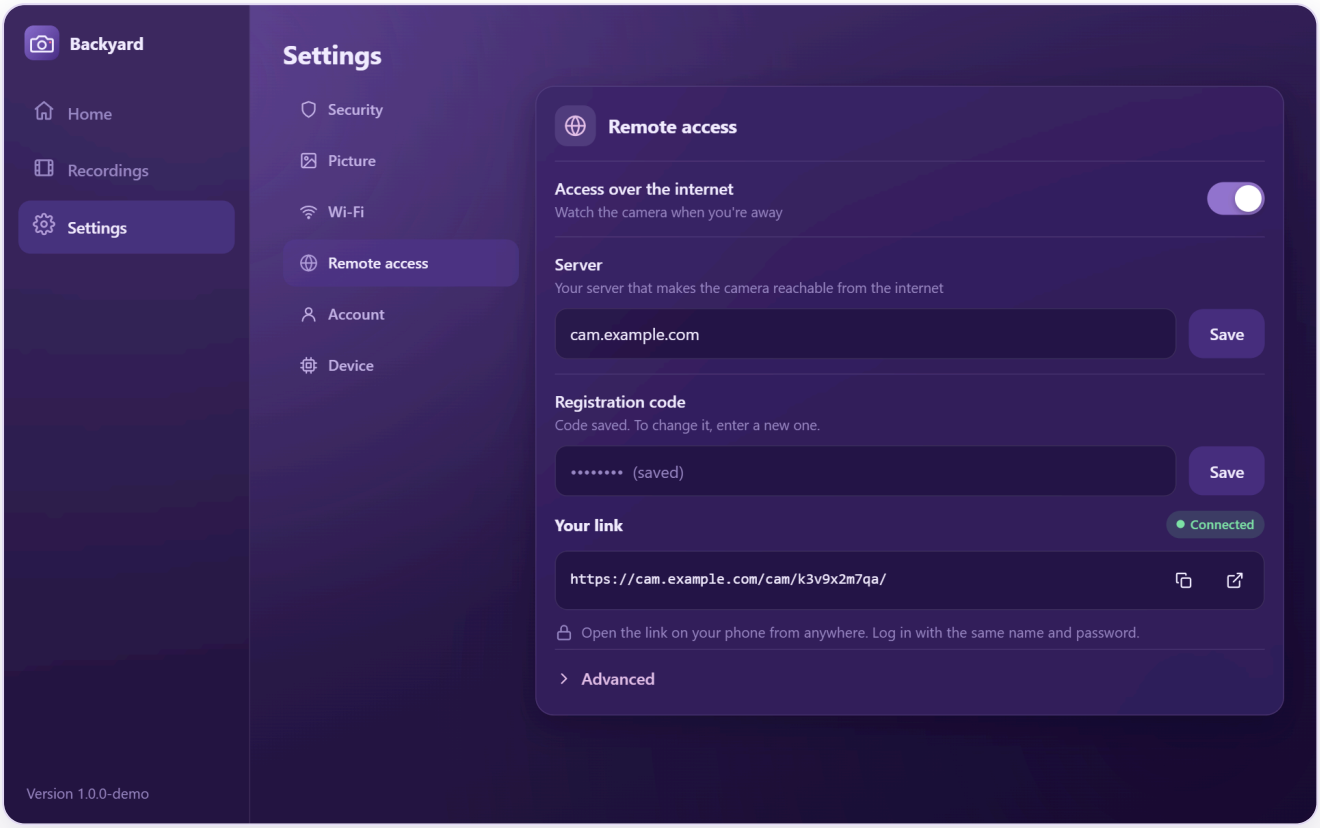
The Security section on a computer

Section	What you can change
Security	motion sensitivity, how long to keep recording after motion, clip length, lamp while recording
Picture	video quality, brightness, contrast, saturation, mirror and rotate — with a live preview
Wi-Fi	move the camera to another network
Remote access	watching the camera over the internet (see section 6)
Account	change the user name and password, log out
Device	camera name, colour scheme, language, time zone, clearing the card, firmware update, restart

💡 **Recording shadows or trees?** Lower the **Motion sensitivity** . **Missing real motion?** Raise it.

6 Access from the internet

Watch the camera from work or on holiday — no router configuration needed.



Settings → Remote access

1. Open **Settings → Remote access**.
2. Turn on **Access over the internet**.
3. Enter the **server** address and **registration code** given to you by whoever set up the camera. (If the camera was prepared in advance, they're already filled in.)
4. When **● Connected** appears, copy **Your link** and open it on your phone. Log in with the same name and password.

🔒 **The link is the key to your camera.** Share it only with people you trust. If it ends up in the wrong hands, open **Advanced** and tap **New link** — the old one stops working immediately.

7 Troubleshooting

Answers to the most common questions.

Forgot the password

1. Press the **RST** button on the camera **three times in a row**, about a second apart.
2. The camera opens the `ESP32-Camera-XXXX` network again.
3. Connect to it — a page opens where you can set a new login, password and, if needed, Wi-Fi.

Recordings on the memory card are kept.

Problem	What to do
I can't see the ESP32-Camera-XXXX network	Wait a minute after powering on. Check the power supply: a weak charger is the most common cause of restarts.
The setup page didn't open by itself	Open a browser and go to `192.168.4.1`.
The camera won't connect to Wi-Fi	Check the password. The camera works with 2.4 GHz only — make sure that band is enabled on the router.
The camera's address won't open	Your phone must be on the same home network as the camera. Try the numeric address `http://192.168.x.x/`.
Wi-Fi is gone, or the camera moved	After a minute the camera opens `ESP32-Camera-XXXX`. Join it, log in with your usual password and, if needed, choose the new network in **Settings → Wi-Fi**. The internet link stays the same.
“Too many failed attempts”	Several wrong passwords were entered. Wait the time shown and try again.
No recordings appear	Check that **Security** is on and the memory card is inserted (up to 32 GB, FAT32).
Too many unwanted recordings	Lower the motion sensitivity and remove things that move in the wind from the view.
The picture is upside down	**Settings → Picture**: turn on **Flip** and **Mirror**.
Dark or washed-out picture	**Settings → Picture**: brightness and contrast.